

Making homeschooling a success for the whole family.



VOLUNTEER AGREEMENT:

Helping others to find peace in the balance of learning and living;
this co-op was created by homeschool parents for all parents who want more.

BRIEF OVERVIEW

At American Seekers Academy, a drop off homeschool co-op, we have a shared goal in helping to make homeschooling a success for the whole family. Our program is inspired by the Classical model of education and includes subjects pertaining to the Trivium and Quadrivium. We outsource several of the curriculums along with the general overview and layout of course materials and lesson plans. We also incorporate original, proprietary works such as worksheets, lessons and projects into our scope and buildout of schedules. Hillsdale College, Literacy Essentials, IEW, Robert Woodson Institute, Dimensions Math, Saxon Math, PragerU, MENSA and Tuttle Twins are some of the reputable sources we purchase materials from, reference and use to guide lessons.

We are a universal co-op that welcomes families from all faith traditions. Lessons may include examining the role of the Creator in our founding documents and as contained within the design of our government. We do not teach religious doctrine nor do we exclude the word God from our lessons pertaining to the relationship and role God plays in our American founding, history, and within the context of philosophy, mathematics and scientific discovery and debate. **There is holiday time off during our 10 week sessions.** Students will observe American holidays and learn about International holidays in class as they occur except for Halloween depending on the location and their rules.

Our program as a whole teaches socialism leads to communism and why capitalism and liberty go hand in hand. "The Truths We Still Hold," by Matthew Spalding and "Land of Hope," by Wilfred McClay are both required readings for our Mentors as general guides on American history. Please familiarize yourself with these books at your pace and ask for clarification regarding any topics or subject matter.

You must agree to a full 10 week commitment unless instructing a 5 week afternoon extracurricular. We hope that you enjoy instructing and mentoring from the structure we are providing. We need mentors to remain inspired and encouraging of their students, to relatively improvise lessons and activities when necessary and to help each student to perform their best academically and to strongly improve in the area of reading and writing.

We hope that you enjoy this structured educational routine and social space we are proudly establishing together. Our Mentors come with experience and an overall ability to inspire and encourage their students, improvise lessons and activities when necessary and administer the rules and expectations required of the American Seekers Academy, its directors, parents and space we occupy. Mentors must be effective at assisting students to perform their best academically. We aim to strongly influence the improvement and overall growth in the areas of reading and writing, civics and self governance.

You will know your student's best, their likes and dislikes, natural abilities and inclinations. Please let the coordinator's know if you have any supply requests, book suggestions, guest speakers or ideas for lessons and activities you believe your students would really enjoy and benefit from. Always give us your honest feedback as we continue to grow and develop this unique homeschooling experience for everyone.

Our Mission

We are aiming to provide homeschool families access to a private, in-person classical education that guarantees parents' right to choose what is best for their child. Our drop off program helps make homeschooling a success for the whole family and cultivates civic virtue while preparing students for a life of freedom and intellectual growth.

1. All aspects of the American Seekers Academy including but not limited to: the materials, lesson plans, curriculums, class projects, crafts and activities are considered Property of American Seekers Academy and may not be altered or reproduced, distributed or sold during or after the period of volunteership. Any lessons created or influenced by Mentors or Aides are the sole property of ASA. ASA reserves the exclusive right to sell, distribute or market any and all aspects of the program. Photos will be taken periodically and throughout the year and used for marketing purposes, emailed, printed and shared on social media and other platforms. All members, Mentors, Aides and volunteers agree to keeping all intellectual property, proprietary information and data, business and organizational strategies, innovative concepts, personal information about Members and Owners, Agreements, training sessions and meetings confidential during and after the period of volunteership.
2. Membership places us together under the protection of the 1st and 14th amendments to the Constitution to conduct our organization in the full protection of privacy ;
 - a. Your membership fee is covered by donations made to ASA for the first year that you are continuously mentoring.
3. We are NOT a public, government, or private school; there are not any medical benefits, nor a " paycheck ", which means no yearly tax forms; a bi-weekly offering in the form of a cash gift will be given, think biblical terms; what you choose to do with that cash is at your discretion during tax season; your official title is not, " teacher", or " educator", it is Mentor, Aide or Volunteer; We are a ministry, serving children and parents;
4. We are operating under a **privately operated homeschool cooperative association**, which is why we are able to organize and execute this style of learning the way we are; We will have the children less than 51% of the time, so we are well within the boundaries of NYS Homeschool Instruction Regulations, even though we don't have to be; and if you are ever asked what you do you will respond with, "I am a mentor or volunteer for homeschooled children in a private, parent group", You do not "work for" the ministry; **You are a volunteer who receives an offering in the form of a gift bi-weekly and in cash form;**
5. Parents understand and agree to leave American Seekers Academy Ministries and your name off of their school documentation;
6. Our program runs three days per week, Monday, Wednesday and Friday and may include camps and additional classes during off days.
7. Volunteers are assigned a unique building security code to enter and will arrive between 8:30 and 8:40 AM and meet for the Pledge at 8:55 AM. Codes will not work prior to 8:30 AM or after 3:00 PM. Classes begin at 9 AM and will conclude by 12 PM. Extended class periods will end no later than 2 PM; special events will vary in times. If a child is not picked up on time, a coordinator or in special cases, a volunteer will remain onsite until they are retrieved by the rightful person.
8. Mentors and Aides can expect at least one in person training session before the start of each session. There may also be a need for a touch base regarding any changes to rules of conduct, systems and procedures and technical training.
9. Mentors will be briefed on the daily schedule in the morning before classes begin. The Daily Flow is provided every morning for Mentors to review and Parents to take a snapshot.
10. While encouraged to provide coordinators with your ideas and suggested lessons or activities, Mentors must receive approval from the Coordinator for anything that is not already provided on the Daily Flow including lectures, lessons, art projects, historical events and political or other topics of discussion. ASA ensures only vetted materials and lessons to safeguard the Mentor's educational choices and parent's trust. With approval, Mentors can use their own props or supplies they need to be successful as long as they do not advocate a personal opinion, a political movement, action group or agenda or is anti-American;
11. Mentors must get the "OK" from the Coordinator to send home any homework or memos with the student.
12. Members including mentors and volunteers may only bring their own children to the co-op in situations where they have no other option. Children not enrolled must arrive with their own entertainment and snacks. Due to planning and budgeting restraints, extra materials, supplies and lesson plans will not be provided for children that are not enrolled with exceptions such as toys, basic coloring materials, restrooms, drinking fountain and microwave.

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13. Mentors may purchase decorations and supplies to elevate and personalize their classroom environment and must seek approval from the Coordinator or Director. If reimbursement is needed, budget and approval must be given prior to purchase.
14. Mentors must communicate to the Coordinator and Director any behavioral issues or perceived educational obstacles and receive the "OK" before communicating any issues with the parents directly. Mentors may provide their opinions and observations to parents who ask them directly in a brief and positive manner and provide parents with feedback on the 10 week progress report. Mentors will be provided a progress report to fill out for each student making note of any achievement hurdles and successes and a personalized note of particular strengths and qualities observed.
15. Mentors help to keep their classrooms clean and orderly. Aides can be assigned to manage the tidiness during classroom activities. Classrooms must be restored to their original state at the end of day (12 PM or 2 PM). Mentors may need to stay a few minutes after class ends to ensure cleanliness of their space including wiping down toys, white boards, tables, chairs and vacuuming. Students are required to contribute to all clean up duties.
16. Our mentors are genuinely moved by the transformative nature of the Liberal Arts and have a fervent desire to teach, and be an uplifting source of encouragement for all students.
17. Volunteers must abide at all times by ASA's disciplinary codes which place responsibility in the hands of the parents first and foremost. Volunteers are required to intervene and provide the proper script for students involved in all situations where there is any inappropriate conduct, harsh language or a disgruntled attitude. Coordinators will help decide the best disciplinary course of action when situations arise choosing from a list of several different pre-designed consequences.
18. Meetings and touch bases and direct communication via phone and email are required throughout the duration of the year. Please remain flexible as we grow.
19. We will maintain an "open door" policy, whereas parents will be allowed to remain in the building and check in on their children during class hours, like a homeschool co-op, should they choose to do so; This is their children's education and we will never shut them out; We will make sure boundaries are established so that your lessons are not interrupted or infringed upon, but view the parents who choose to stay as classroom aides;
20. Our building and our community within it, will be a safe, sacred space for our children; we will never indoctrinate, force our own biased medical, political beliefs or ideologies, share information that is opinion vs fact (unless the lesson deems it appropriate), and will treat each other and the children with respect and integrity; disregard individual hurdles helping each student to achieve success at a mutually desired pace. Parents will be notified beforehand otherwise we are not to teach or expose students to anything that may be considered gory, shocking, mature in nature or frightening even if historically accurate and seemingly important including but not limited to: the brutality of war and the nature of human biology, reproduction, etc. The children's well-being, the parents' satisfaction, and the mission of our organization needs to be upheld at all times.
21. Mentors may not wear masks or face coverings during co-op hours or co-op related functions to ensure proper communication and functioning and to foster a sense of unity over fear.
22. The Brighton location has a banned food list according to [Leviticus 11](#) and includes shellfish and pork. All drinks, food and snacks provided by ASA are always organic vegan and include a plant based, gluten free option. ASA provides snacks to those who need it only either for forgetting to bring enough food or needs energy to stay focused.
23. Volunteer Mentor and Aide positions and rates are contingent on class sign ups and may be canceled or restructured at any point if there are not enough students. The American Seekers Academy's President can terminate a membership and cancel any class at their discretion and only after thorough evaluation of circumstances.
24. Mentors agree to return ASA Mentor Guide binder and all other materials, books and student work to the coordinator upon leaving the role or program altogether. Classes may need to be reassigned a new mentor, aide or volunteer at any time and for any reason including the idea that the mentor will be a better fit elsewhere and which may result in a change in rate. Additional volunteers serving as mentors and aides may take over the role of an existing volunteer if classes drop or are combined and to help secure the reopening of new locations with volunteers having previous experience with the ASA program or that might have a particular skill set that is needed for a specific age group and to create and maintain a diverse and well rounded team of volunteers at all times.
25. All supplies and materials belonging to American Seekers Academy such as the Mentor Guide take home binder must be returned promptly and may be scheduled to be picked up or dropped off with one of the board members. Any materials, curriculums and supplies belonging to ASA must be labeled, checked out by a board member and documented.
26. ASA is in the early stages of its startup and may need to make amendments and revisions to any and all agreement(s) ; All parties should and will always communicate any changes that are needed;

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Annual Dues:

Mentors are to pay \$25 annually to American Seekers Academy Ministries to maintain their membership with our organization. Mentor Membership Fee is non refundable.

Offering:

Mentor agrees to the hourly pay rate in the form of a **donation** outlined in the Mentor Schedule; Mentors are paid only for in class working hours and will not receive pay for the time filled in by Aides or Substitutes, coming in early before class begins or staying late to clean, for meetings and touch bases or for the time it takes to correct homework or to provide progress report feedback. You will be responsible for all documents relating to taxation at the end of the year as we are not responsible for any withholdings;

I have read and agree to the Volunteer Agreement.

_____ Mentor/ Aide Printed Name

Date

Mentor/ Aide Signature

Corey Brown _____ President Printed Name

Date

Corey Brown
President Signature